

The Dhāraṇī Called That Which Cultivates Wisdom

Prajñāvardhanī nāma dhāraṇī · Toh 719 · Derge Kangyur

ཤེས་རབ་སྒྱུ་པ་ཞེས་བྱའགྱུར་ཅིང་།

Toh 719 in the Kangyur is a short dhāraṇī text known in English as "That Which Cultivates Wisdom," in Sanskrit as the Prajñāvardhanī nāma dhāraṇī, and in Tibetan as the Shes rab skyed pa zhes bya ba'i gzungs. It belongs to the dhāraṇī class of canonical literature, presenting a brief but potent mantra accompanied by a simple ritual instruction: the mantra is to be recited three times over warm water, which is then drunk, with the promise that within seven days the practitioner will gain the ability to retain whatever they have heard. The text is closely associated with the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, to whom homage is paid at the outset, and its single mantra — Galate galate manite svāhā — forms the heart of the entire work. It was translated into Tibetan by the Indian master Jñānagarbha together with the Tibetan monk-translator Nāgadbang.

In the Indian language: Prajñāvardhanī nāma dhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: The dhāraṇī called "That Which Cultivates Wisdom."

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the noble Avalokiteśvara, bodhisattva, great being.

Thus: Galate galate manite svāhā.

The ritual application of this knowledge mantra is as follows. Recite it three times over warm water and drink it, and within seven days one will come to retain what one has heard.

The dhāraṇī called "That Which Cultivates Wisdom" is complete.

Translated by the Indian master Jñānagarbha and the Tibetan translator, the monk Nāgadbang —

Translator's Notes

- The colophon is incomplete; the text breaks off mid-sentence after naming the Tibetan translator, whose name appears to begin "Nāga-dbang" (Nāgadbang), but the full name is not given in the passage. The mantra transliteration follows the Tibetan phonetic rendering as given; the underlying Sanskrit reconstruction of "galate galate manite" is plausible but the Tibetan orthography (with the unusual consonant cluster rendered as sga-la-te) is non-standard and the precise Sanskrit original is uncertain.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.